

STATE OF NEW YORK

10543--A

IN ASSEMBLY

March 11, 2026

Introduced by M. of A. REYES, SEPTIMO, MEEKS -- read once and referred to the Committee on Health -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the public health law, in relation to requiring health-care facilities to maintain a fifty percent operating threshold of certain reusable healthcare protective textiles in their inventory

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. Section 2803 of the public health law is amended by adding a new subdivision 15 to read as follows:

15. (a) The commissioner shall ensure that all healthcare facilities as defined in paragraph (b) of this subdivision possess and maintain an operating threshold of at least fifty percent of all healthcare protective textiles (HPT) as provided by a hygienically clean laundry service provider; provided, however, that upon request, the department may grant an extension or reprieve, at its sole and exclusive discretion if the healthcare facility demonstrates, to the commissioner's satisfaction, that such healthcare facility's inability to meet such requirement is solely attributable to supply chain issues that are beyond the hospital's control and purchasing HPT at market rates would facilitate price gouging by HPT vendors.

(b) For purposes of this subdivision, the following terms shall have the following meanings:

(i) "healthcare facility" shall mean hospitals, skilled nursing facilities, outpatient care centers, long-term care facilities, physical therapy centers, comprehensive outpatient rehabilitation facilities, end-stage renal disease facilities, hospice, physician's offices, non-physician provider's offices, and laboratories;

(ii) "healthcare protective textiles" shall mean all types of barrier garments, incontinence pads and barrier curtains; and

(iii) "operating threshold" shall mean a constantly rotating stock of HPT textiles being used, returned to a laundry facility, processed by a hygienically clean certified facility, and returned to a healthcare facility for use.

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 (c) Failure to possess and maintain such a supply of HPT may result in
2 a fine to be determined by the department; provided, however, that no
3 such revocation or suspension shall be ordered unless the department has
4 provided the healthcare facility with a thirty-day grace period, to
5 achieve compliance with the requirements of paragraph (a) of this subdi-
6 vision.

7 § 2. This act shall take effect one year after it shall have become a
8 law.